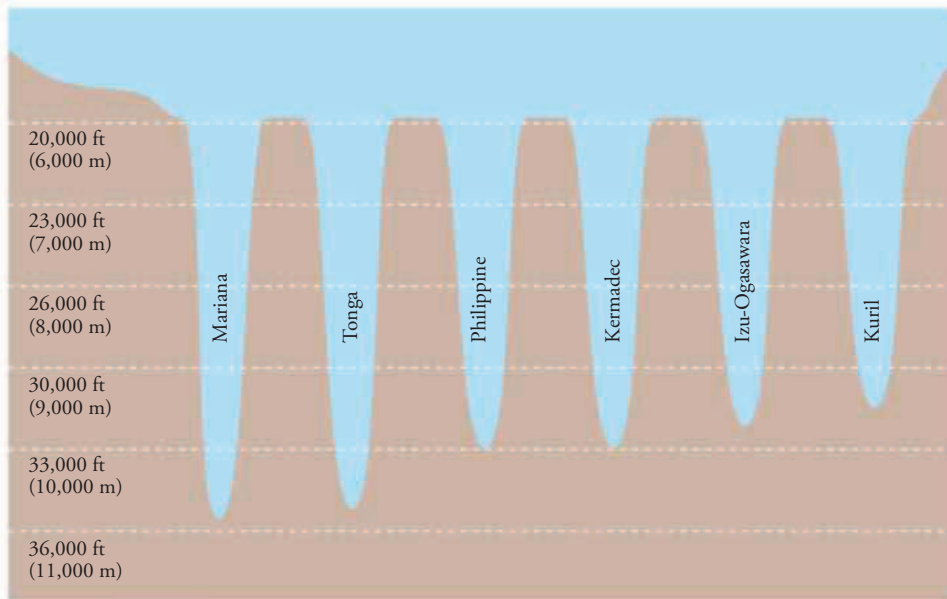


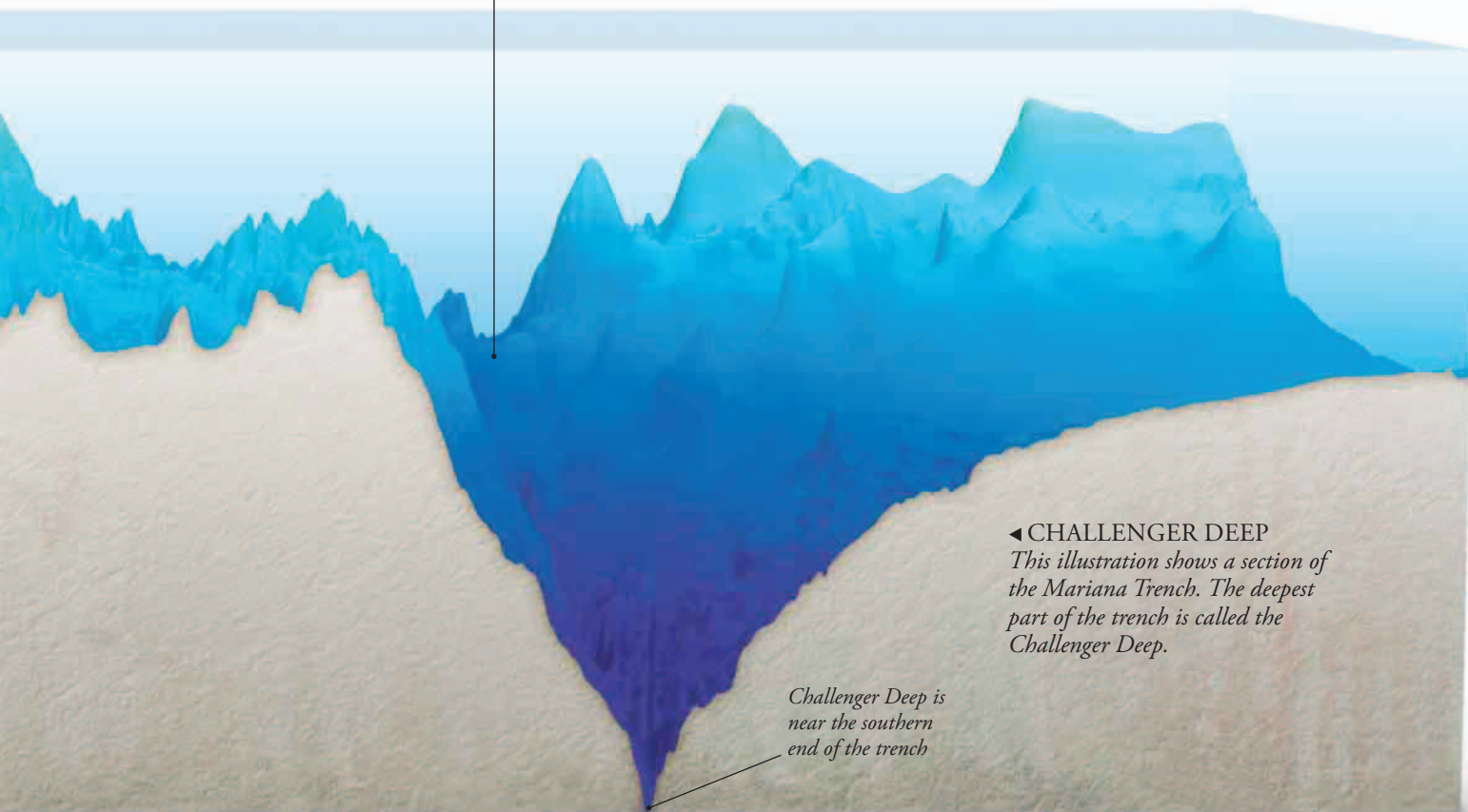
PACIFIC TRENCHES

All the world's ocean floors have deep trenches formed by the subduction process, but the deepest of them are found in and around the Pacific. This diagram shows how far below the surface they lie. Even the Kuril Trench to the north of Japan is deeper than the height of Mount Everest, which soars to 29,029 ft (8,848 m) above sea level.



World's deepest trenches

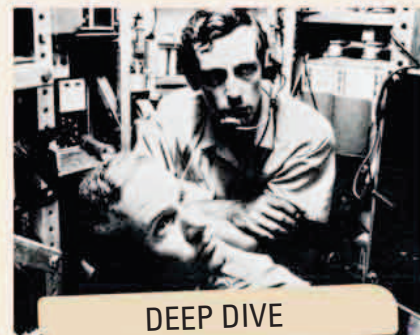
*Trench is about 22,638 ft
(6,900 m) wide*



◀ CHALLENGER DEEP

This illustration shows a section of the Mariana Trench. The deepest part of the trench is called the Challenger Deep.

Challenger Deep is near the southern end of the trench



DEEP DIVE

In 1960, Jacques Piccard and Don Walsh descended to the bottom of the Mariana Trench in the submersible *Trieste*. Their tiny crew capsule was suspended from a huge gasoline-filled float, weighed down with iron pellets. The dive took them 4 hours and 48 minutes, and this is still the deepest dive ever made.

